Maxence Debes

maxence.debes@polytechnique.edu | +33 7 81 32 79 22 | Paris, France
maxencedbe.github.io | maxence-debes | maxencedbe

Specialized in Machine Learning and AI, with a strong academic background in Mathematics and Computer Science. I enjoy solving complex technical problems by combining mathematical rigor with advanced Python to build robust, data-driven solutions.
Currently seeking a full-time position.

Education

École Polytechnique — Polytechnic Institute of Paris 2025 – 2026
MSc Data Science, *with highest honours*
Relevant coursework: *ALTEGRAD (joint MVA course), Deep Learning, Reinforcement Learning, Representation Learning (MVA), Generative Models, Optimization for Data Science.*

Télécom SudParis — Polytechnic Institute of Paris 2023 – 2026
Master's degree in Computer Science and Applied Mathematics
Relevant coursework: *Statistics and Data Analysis, Optimization, Machine Learning and Data Mining, Stochastic Processes, Continuous Optimization for Learning and Machine Learning.*

Projects

Hi! PARIS Hi!ckathon 2025 (2nd place)
- Ranked 2nd out of 80+ teams in the 2025 edition of the Hi! PARIS Data Science hackathon. Task: Predicting student PISA scores from complex socio-economic backgrounds.
- Engineered a gated model routing each sample to one of two XGBoost regressors based on a feature threshold, achieving an R^2 of 0.79 on the public leaderboard.

Molecular Graph Captioning (Kaggle competition)
- Built a retrieval-based architecture using contrastive learning to align molecular graph embeddings with natural language descriptions in a joint latent space.
- Implemented a dedicated graph neural network encoder using PyTorch Geometric, optimized for semantic alignment through BERTScore and BLEU-4 metrics.

Streaming Safety Classifier for LLMs — Capstone Project with DragonLLM (now OVHai LLM)
- Reproduced the Qwen3Guard toxicity classifier: built a dataset of 24K toxic and safe Q&A samples, synthesized and token-level labeled with Qwen3-30B.
- Trained a lightweight per-token safety head on a frozen Qwen backbone to interrupt harmful generations in real time.

Data Privacy & Anonymization — Project Cassiopée
- Assessed privacy and re-identification risks in anonymized datasets through OSINT case studies, and proposed data-protection strategies. Conducted at Télécom SudParis.

Automated Parking Optimization
- Developed a Python optimization model for vehicle placement in multi-level automated parking, combining A* and simulated annealing to minimize retrieval costs.

Work Experience

Data Science Intern — ChemAI | Munich, Germany Apr 2026 – Oct 2026
- Designed the architecture of, and built, a graph database of over 30M chemical reactions.
- Ran graph-native analyses to surface insights on the data's diversity, structure and reaction patterns.
- Trained ML models that leverage the graph structure for predictive analytics on chemical reactions.

Data Governance Intern — Batigère Maison Familiale | Metz, France Jul 2025 – Aug 2025
- Migrated the company to SharePoint — adopted by 100% of employees — and designed a GDPR compliance policy reinforcing data security.

Software Engineer Intern — Atos | Metz, France Jul 2024 – Aug 2024
- Designed and implemented a telework tracking application using the JHipster application generator to facilitate accessibility to workstations.

Skills & Interests

Technical Skills: Python, Java, SQL | PyTorch, PyG, Transformers, PEFT (LoRA/QLoRA), Scikit-learn, NumPy, SciPy, Pandas, Matplotlib | vLLM, Ollama, Unsloth, Neo4j, Weights & Biases | Git, Docker, Bash, Linux, LaTeX
Soft Skills: Leadership, teamwork, adaptability, technical communication
Languages: French (native), English (C1 – TOEIC 965/990), German (A2)
Engagement & Interests: Former president of a student association, competitive handball, music